Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ J 10 9 7 3 ♥ A 8 2 ♦ 6 2 ♣ A 7 5	
♠ A 8 2 ♥ J 9 7 4 ♦ K J 10 5 3 ♣ J		♠ 5 4 ♥ Q 10 6 3 ♦ 9 8 ♣ Q 8 4 3 2
	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K 5 ♦ A Q 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown.

Yes this is exactly the same hand you held in Deal 8. You still open 1NT. This time partner responds 3♠.

Partner shows 10+ points and exactly 5 ♠s. This time, with 3-card support, you choose game in ♠s, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 2
East Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 9
♥ 8 3
♦ A K J 10 8 2
♣ J 8

♠ 8 7 5 3
♥ A 10 9 6
♦ 6 3
♣ 7 5 2

♠ J 4 2
♥ J 7 5 2
♦ 9 5
♣ A Q 4 3

♠ K Q 6
♥ K Q 4
♦ Q 7 4
♣ K 10 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠7

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner says 3♦. It's your bid.

Partner has a great hand. A jump to 3 in a Minor suit almost always shows slam interest. But that's partner with interest, not you. You couldn't have a more minimum 1NT opening bid.

So you just return to 3NT. Partner gives up and passes.

Board 3
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ A 8 5 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A Q 8 7 5 4	
♠ J 10 9 2 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q 10 8 2 ♣ 3 2		♠ A 8 7 5 4 ♥ J 10 7 2 ♦ 9 6 5 ♣ J
	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ A 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♣ by North
Lead: ♦5

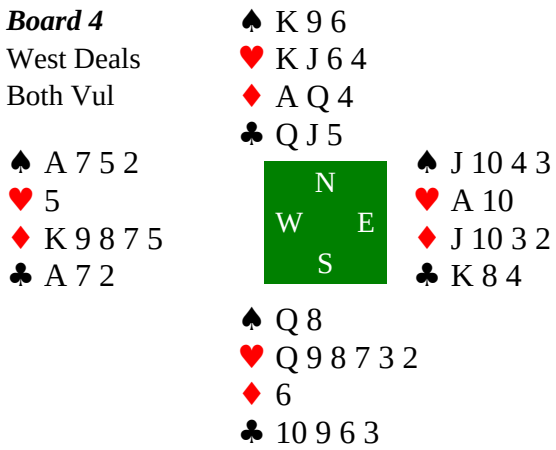
The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	1NT	Pass	2♥
All Pass			

2♥ by South
Lead: ♦5

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.